Four guessed variables bring every $\ell = 8$ draw back to degree 4

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_guess_20261022/`; the full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic.

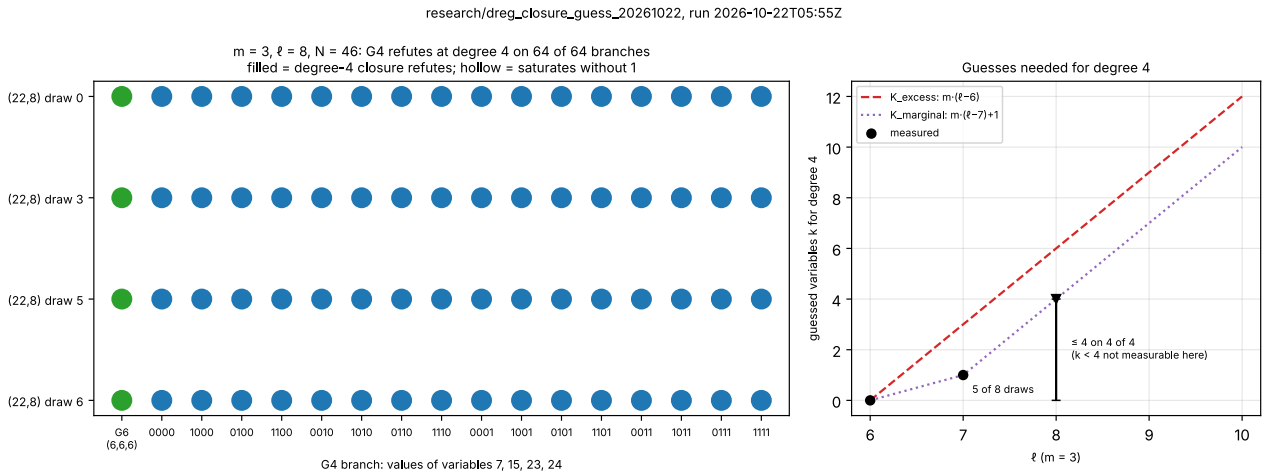

Figure 1: 4 draws × (G6 + 16 G4 branches), run 2026-10-22T05:55Z.

- **Registered verdict: K_marginal favoured, four guesses suffice at $\ell = 8$.** All 64 branches of the four-variable guess refute at degree 4; the dimension-6 positive control refutes on 4 of 4. K_excess, which predicted 6 guesses, is rejected for this guess set.
- **An upper bound:** k = 4 is the fewest guesses this container can measure at N = 46. A k that stays bounded as ℓ grows is not excluded.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):**
  - The guess-then-degree-4 oracle `2^k · C(N−k, ≤4)^w` beats degree 5 at the priced m = 4, ℓ = 33 cell only if k ≤ 6. Both linear rules give k ≈ 105–108 there.
  - Its best case is the degree-4 row itself, `2^68.43` (`2^+7.62` over rho), still contradicted until k is shown to stay bounded.
  - No row moves, and no row beats rho.
- **Next:** k = 3 at ℓ = 8 (136,698 columns, possibly within this host at `--max-cols 140000`), then ℓ = 9 on a larger host.